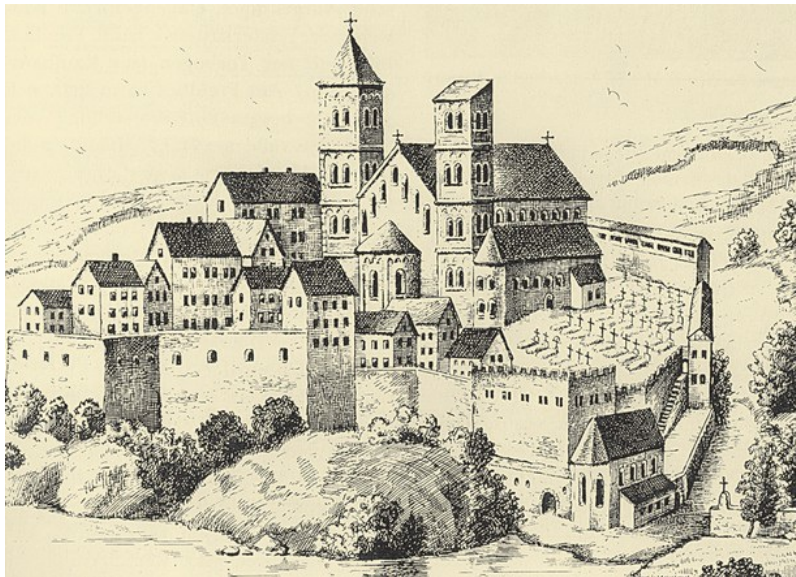


that her music received little attention—it is only since the 1980s that Hildegard’s pioneering achievements in this field have been recognized. Her legacy also extends to an impressive body of writing on medicine, science, cosmology, and the natural world. She has acquired almost iconic status in some circles, particularly within feminism, and is the subject of great popular and scholarly interest.



RUPERTSBERG MONASTERY

The monastery at Rupertsberg in Bingen, on the junction of the Rhine and Nahe rivers, was founded by Hildegard in c. 1148. It was destroyed in 1632 by the Swedish army in the Thirty Years’ War.

IN CONTEXT

Poet-musicians of the 12th century

As well as her undoubted knowledge of Gregorian chant and the religious music of the day, Hildegard may have been familiar with the *trouvères*, aristocratic poet-